

1. Quoting Sean Lynch

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-19T22:45:49+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/19/sean-lynch/#atom-everything>

The real valuable capability MCP offers over skills/CLI is isolating the auth flow outside of the agent's context window, and potentially out of the harness completely. [...] Maybe the idealized form of MCP is just an auth gateway for the API and nothing else. That'd still be a win. ? Sean Lynch , comment on Hacker News Tags: model-context-protocol , llms , ai , generative-ai , skills

2. datasette 1.0a34

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-16T21:31:24+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/16/datasette/#atom-everything>

Release: datasette 1.0a34 Quoting the release notes: The big feature in this alpha is tools to insert, edit and delete rows within the Datasette interface. These features are available on table pages, and edit and delete are also available as action items on the row page. The inspiration for this feature - which is long overdue - was Datasette Agent . I added SQL write support to that the other day which highlighted how absurd it was that you could insert and edit ties via the chat interface but not in the regular Datasette UI! Tags: projects , datasette , annotated-release-notes

3. Quoting Matteo Wong, The Atlantic

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-06-16T03:07:54+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jun/16/matteo-wong-the-atlantic/#atom-everything>

Katie Moussouris, a cybersecurity expert and the CEO of Luta Security, told me that Anthropic shared with her a copy of the White House's report on the Fable jailbreak to get her appraisal. (She said that she is not being paid by Anthropic.) The report, Moussouris said, involved IT experts asking Fable to help find and patch bugs. When given deliberately insecure code, she said, Fable refused the prompt ?review the code for security issues? but then complied when asked to ?fix this code,? followed by some further manual steps. Moussouris told me that this was just ?the model working as intended? for cyberdefense. ? Matteo Wong, The Atlantic , The White House Is Ratcheting Up Its War Against Anthropic Tags: anthropic , claude , ai , llms , ai-ethics , jailbreaking , generative-ai , ai-security-research , claude-mythos

4. Another One for the ?Sorry, We Used to Be Crap? Truth-in-Advertising File: Carlsberg Beer

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-20T01:29:29Z

Link: <https://www.independent.co.uk/news/business/news/carlsberg-probably-not-best-beer-in-world-lager-brewer-a8874016.html>

Ben Chapman, reporting for The Independent in 2019: After 40 years of advertising its lager as ?Probably the best beer in the world?, Danish brewer Carlsberg has confessed that the famous slogan may not be true. Reacting to falling sales and increasingly harsh comments from drinkers about the taste of its beer, Carlsberg has launched a new recipe along with a more honest approach to marketing. The campaign declares: ?Probably not the best beer in the world. So we've changed it. Somewhere along the line, we lost our way. We focused on brewing quantity, not quality. We became one of the cheapest, not the best.? As part of the new ad campaign Carlsberg is sharing negative comments about the old beer including, ?Carlsberg tastes like stale breadsticks? and another comparing it to ?drinking the bathwater your nan died in?. I drank a Carlsberg once. Once . ?

5. ?What's the Deal With Old Guys and Giant Glasses??

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-20T01:21:19Z

Link: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8DYGxn6Xvt0>

Early adoption of new technology is generally considered a young-person thing, but maybe Snap Specs will turn that notion on its head. Direct sales in retirement homes? ?

6. Trump Mobile T1 Phone Is a Gold-Painted Two-Year-Old HTC U24 Pro

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-06-19T18:47:02Z

Link: <https://www.nbcnews.com/tech/gadgets/trump-mobile-t1-phone-nearly-identical-htc-device-analysis-rcna349293>

NBC News: The Trump Mobile T1 phone, originally marketed as "Made in the USA," is nearly identical to the two-year-old HTC U24 Pro, a phone made by the Taiwanese company HTC using Chinese parts, according to a technical analysis the repair-guide and parts company iFixit conducted in partnership with NBC News. That report is paywalled, but NBC News's five-minute video is on YouTube , and iFixit has a full teardown report of their own . The only thing that's surprising is that the Trump T1 doesn't cost much more than the HTC-branded one (\$500 vs. \$470). ?

7. Some reasons why your server may not be doing a UEFI network boot

Source: Chris's Wiki :: blog | Published: 2026-06-19T03:30:46Z

Link: <https://utcc.utoronto.ca/~cks/space/blog/sysadmin/WhyServerNotUEFINetworkBoot>

In theory, network booting with UEFI is fairly straightforward. Unlike the earlier BIOS based network booting, UEFI defines network booting in the standard itself (although it's not required). In practice, vendors of x86 servers have found any number of creative ways to put stumbling blocks in your way in their firmware (aka 'BIOS'). Here's an incomplete list of reasons that your server might not be willing to do a UEFI network boot the way you expect it. The firmware might not even be in UEFI mode, in which case at best it's trying to do BIOS PXE boot, which requires a different set of support infrastructure on your boot server that may not be there (cf , also). There's no UEFI network booting option (or options) in the server's UEFI boot order. The UEFI network boot option is trying to boot from the wrong interface (on a server with multiple interfaces). The firmware only supports UEFI network booting using the built-in 1G network interfaces, not with your 10G-T add-in PCIe card that is actually connected to your network. UEFI network booting is enabled in the boot order, but your firmware settings have disabled network booting for all network devices that the firmware will tr...

8. There Are No Instances in atproto

Source: overreacted ? A blog by Dan Abramov | Published: Fri, 19 Jun 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://overreacted.io/there-are-no-instances-in-atproto/>

Like RSS and Google Reader.

9. Arp 29: The fireworks galaxy

Source: Maurycy's Blog | Published: Fri, 19 Jun 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://maurycyz.com/astro/arp29/>

North is right. 0.55"/pixel (26'x26' field). FWHM=3.7" This one is in the Atlas of Peculiar Galaxies under "one heavy arm", which checks out: the eastern arm (down) is considerably brighter and denser than the others. However, it's mostly known for it's bright star formation, and being close enough and it's close enough to resolve multiple HII regions and a bright star cluster: It's also had ten observed supernova, hence "fireworks galaxy". In the sky, it appears very close to the milky way , which can be seen as the unusually dense star field. Also, there's a lot of dust blocking the galaxy's light which results in it's low surface brightness. It also makes luminosity measurements unreliable, and because it's too close for accurate redshift data ($z=0.00015$), it's hard to tell how far away it is: I'd guess somewhere between 10 and 30 million light years. dt { color: var(--em-color); } Total exposure time: 504 * 30 seconds = 4.2 hours. Used in stack: 417 * 30 seconds = 3.4 hours. Telescope: C9.25 (230mm, f/10, fl=2300mm) + 0.63 Starizona reducer Camera: IMX533 (16mm diagonal, square, color) Processing: Calibration (dark + flat) Stacking (average w/ outlier rejection) White balance and...

10. Glassblowing #2: Making a tungsten lamp and (bad) vacuum diode

Source: Maurycy's Blog | Published: Thu, 18 Jun 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://maurycyz.com/projects/glass/2/>

Now that I have a way to run electrodes through glass, it's time to do something with that. An old school lightbulb is rather simple: just a thin wire that gets hot enough to glow. However, to produce anything approaching white light, the wire must get to around 2500 C. While conductors like tungsten or graphite can survive those temperatures, they all burn on contact with air. To prevent this, I'll be sealing my lamp in glass under vacuum: no air, no problem. I lied. Some ceramics start conducting once heated, and being oxides, are completely unaffected by oxygen. Open air "Nernst lamps" did enjoy brief popularity in the 1890-1900s, but because of the added complexity of preheating the filament, they were replaced by filament lamps once vacuum pumps became good enough for commercial production.

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Nernst_lamp : those lamps.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-spTvp5-sf0> : Using one. To start, I bent some some 0.3mm diameter tungsten wire into a "U" shape, and twisted a length of very fine 0.012 mm tungsten wire onto the free ends. I cut one side of the lead frame shorter so that the filament would sit diagonally: allowing it to be reasonably long without...

11. Converting Coal Plants to Natural Gas

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Fri, 19 Jun 2026 12:03:02 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/converting-coal-plants-to-natural>

For the better part of the last several hundred years, coal was the fuel of choice for generating power.

12. Premium: The Silicon Valley Bubble (Part 2)

Source: Ed Zitron's Where's Your Ed At | Published: Fri, 19 Jun 2026 17:03:48 GMT

Link: <https://www.wheresyoured.at/premium-the-silicon-valley-bubble-part-2/>

So it's been a big week for me after I published an exclusive covering OpenAI's audited financials from 2024 and 2025, with reactions ranging from "oh my god, OpenAI spent \$34 billion to make \$13.07 billion in revenue!" to "actually, it?"

13. Full Page Paralysis

Source: Jim Nielsen's Blog | Published: Fri, 19 Jun 2026 19:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://blog.jim-nielsen.com/2026/full-page-paralysis/>

You've probably heard the term. It's meant to convey how difficult it can be to start something. "Blank page paralysis". But for my money, beginning is easy. Finishing is the hard part. In software, they call it "the last 90%". In logistics, they call it "the last mile". It's that final stretch that's disproportionately hard. Finishing makes something real and finite, subject to judgment. As I near completion, there's a little voice in my head that says, "As long as it's unfinished, there's nothing wrong with it. It's still potentially perfect!" I don't struggle with blank page paralysis. But I am paralyzed in the face of a full page ready for publishing. Reply via: Email • Mastodon • Bluesky

14. The data black hole at the center of AI

Source: Dwarkesh Podcast | Published: Fri, 19 Jun 2026 16:45:03 GMT

Link: <https://www.dwarkesh.com/p/the-sample-efficiency-black-hole-2>

"We see these AIs as a galaxy glittering with capabilities, but at their center, invisible to the naked eye, holding all the constellations together, is an unimaginably massive black hole of data."

15. The Goldilocks Principle in Fantasy Strategy

Source: The Digital Antiquarian | Published: Fri, 19 Jun 2026 16:00:22 +0000

Link: <https://www.filfre.net/2026/06/the-goldilocks-principle-in-fantasy-strategy/>

Although I've played way too many games for way too many hours over the way too many years I've been writing these histories, it's safe to say that I haven't spent more time with any one game than Heroes of Might and Magic II. Partly this was down to circumstance. Heroes II showed up on

the [?]

16. Bobby Prince has died

Source: Old Vintage Computing Research | Published: 2026-06-19T18:45:09.871-07:00

Link: <https://oldvcr.blogspot.com/2026/06/bobby-prince-has-died.html>

Bobby Prince, '90s FPS game musician extraordinaire, has died at 81 . His work in Wolfenstein 3D was fine (especially The Ultimate Challenge) but clearly all of a particular genre, and his contributions to Duke Nukem 3D and Rise of the Triad were solid but overshadowed by Lee Jackson's (exhibit A: Grabbag ; exhibit B: Prince's main theme but Jackson's KISS OFF). Doom, on the other hand ... well. It's not just that these were solid gamer tracks, it's that they sounded good on just about anybody's sound card. We had high quality MIDI on Mac while you schlubs struggled with Sound Blaster Pros and it still didn't sound like a\$\$. That's talent. While everybody will name At Doom's Gate (E1M1) as his best, I claim it is only merely his most memorable, and solely because everyone on the whole stinking planet has played it at least once. Instead, I proffer I Sawed The Demons (E2M1), Untitled (E3M1), and the reworked Wolf 3D holdover Evil Incarnate (Doom II MAP31) as his heaviest and meatiest, Donna To The Rescue (E3M2) as his funkier, The Demons from Adrian's Pen (E2M2) and They're Going To Get You (E2M4) as his creepiest (I love the " car going out of control " feel to E2M2, as Prince h...

17. Pluralistic: The Big Con (19 Jun 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Fri, 19 Jun 2026 20:54:32

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Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/06/19/too-big-to-fact-check/>

Today's links The Big Con: Making the pile of shit bigger won't increase the number of ponies underneath it. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: TVA v SETI@Home; Telemarketers v DHS batphones; Matt Stone's MPAA censorship memo; Stonehenge pocket watch; W3C v security research; Congressional mass-shooting response simulator; Dynastic wealth; Gig economy astroturf; Meta publishes your AI prompts. Upcoming appearances: LA, Menlo Park, Toronto, NYC, Philadelphia, Chicago, London, Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. The Big Con (permalink) Partway through Bridget Read's unmissable chronicle of pyramid ("multi-level marketing") schemes, Little Bosses Everywhere, there comes a dual revelation: no one is selling any product to end-users and no one knows it: <https://pluralistic.net/2025/05/05/free-enterprise-system/#amway-or-the-highway> That is to say, all the hustlers who have spent thousands of dollars on Mary Kay, Herbalife and Amway have failed to move any of their produ...